Welcome to *Flipside.*

Flipside is a mixtape maker for the music you own. Pick a C60 or a C90, fill Side A and Side B, write the label by hand, and give it to someone. It runs on your phone or computer and plays from your Plex server. Powered by myStereo, from Own Your Media Club.



THE SHORT VERSION

- **Open it:** `ownyourmedia.club/flipside/app`, then add it to your Home Screen.
- **Sign in to Plex,** or try the demo songs first.
- **Make a tape:** press `REC`, plan one on the **Sketch Pad**, or turn your phone sideways for the **Workbench**.
- **File it** in a drawer, **play it** on the deck or the TV, and **send it** to someone on your Plex server.
- **Tell BC what happened:** press `✎ NOTE` on the deck any time.

Thank you.

You're one of the first people to make a tape on Flipside, and that means a lot. It's an alpha, so things will break, words will be confusing, and some buttons will be too small. That's exactly what I need to hear about. Every note you send makes it better for the next person, and for the person you make a tape for.

– BC

What's inside

1. Getting started
2. The Cassette Deck
3. Making a tape
4. Planning a tape: the Sketch Pad
5. Drawers, notes and TV Mode
6. The Workbench, labels and the Wishlist
7. Sending, receiving and printing
8. Analog Mode and computers
9. What to test
10. Notes for BC, known limits and fixes

1 · GETTING STARTED

Five minutes from nothing to a tape.

1. **Put it on your Home Screen. iPhone:** open `ownyourmedia.club/flipside/app` in Safari, tap Share, then Add to Home Screen. **Android:** open it in Chrome, tap ⋮, then Add to Home screen or Install app. On a computer, just open the link.

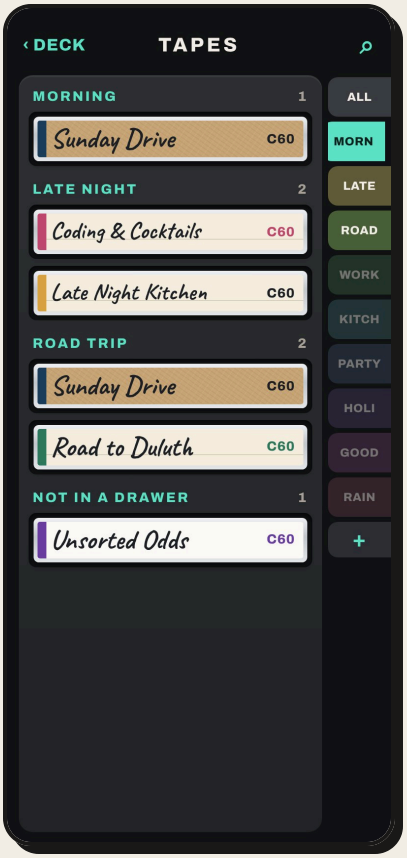
2. **Say hello.** The first time it opens, a welcome card on the deck walks you through it. See it again in Menu › Alpha › Welcome Screen.

3. **Sign in to Plex** from the welcome card, or Menu › Settings › Music Sources › Plex. No Plex handy? Choose the Demo Library and try everything with sample songs.

2 · THE CASSETTE DECK

All buttons, no screens.

`REC`	Starts a new tape.
`STOP/EJECT`	Stops the tape. Press again to open the door: your tape rack fills the screen (see page 5).
`PLAY/PAUSE`	Plays or pauses. The reels turn and the song playing is written on the tape.
`REW` `FF`	Tap to jump back or ahead; hold to wind, with the sound of the tape.
`FLIP`	Turns the tape over. Side B never starts on its own unless you turn on Auto Reverse in Settings.
`⏮ RESTART`	Back to the start of the side you're on. Tapes otherwise pick up where you left off.
☰ SONGS	The track list, written on the J-card. Tapes play in order, so the list is for reading; tap a song on your own tape to add a note.
The lamp	**PLEX**: streaming. **ANALOG**: offline, playing from your phone. **NOT DUBBED**: offline and this tape isn't on the phone.
`✎ NOTE` · TV	NOTE writes BC a note. TV (sideways) opens TV Mode.
Menu	Turns the player over: music, mixtapes, the Sketch Pad, Label Maker, settings and the Alpha menu.



STOP/EJECT opens your tape rack

3 · MAKING A TAPE

When a side is full, it's full.

1. Press **REC**. Name the tape (up to 40 letters) and pick its length: **C60** (30 minutes a side) or **C90** (45 a side).

2. Pick songs anywhere in your library. Every song shows its length; songs too long for the room left are crossed out. Side B fills when Side A is full.

3. Choose **Stop Recording** when you're done. **Arrange Songs** puts them in order: pick one up, turn the knob or tap where it goes, press again to drop it. **+ A Song You Don't Own** saves a spot with links to buy it; add it to Plex and it fills in by itself.

4 · PLANNING A TAPE

The Sketch Pad: plan before you press REC.

A great tape is planned before it's recorded. Menu › **Sketch Pad** › + New Sketch, and it teaches the craft as you go.

Story Arc

Pick a shape: the Classic Arc, Road Trip, For a Crush, Party, Heartbreak, or Bright Side, Late Side. Or build your own beats. Each beat explains its job ("Opener: say hello").

The Crate

The maybe pile. Grab anything that might fit, in any order, no time limit. Then move the keepers into the **Running Order**, under the beat where they belong.

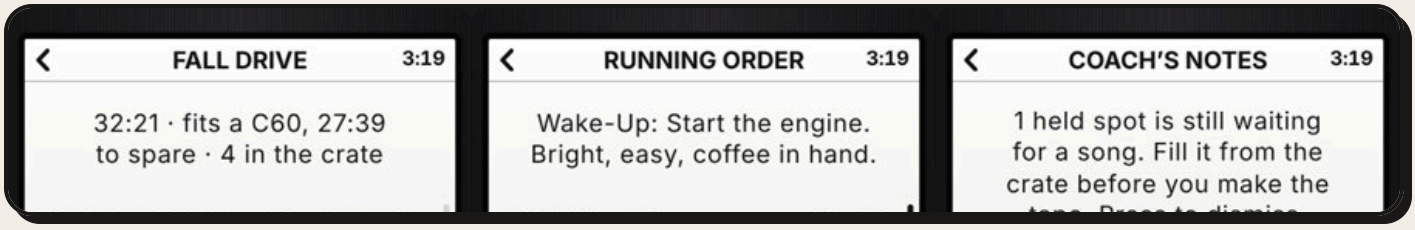
Hold a Spot · Why It's Here

Hold room for "something slow, about 4 minutes" before you know the song. Add a note to any song about why it made the tape.

The Mixtape Coach

Gentle notes on the rules of thumb: an artist twice in a row, a long opener, the song before the flip. Dismiss any note, or turn the coach off in Settings.

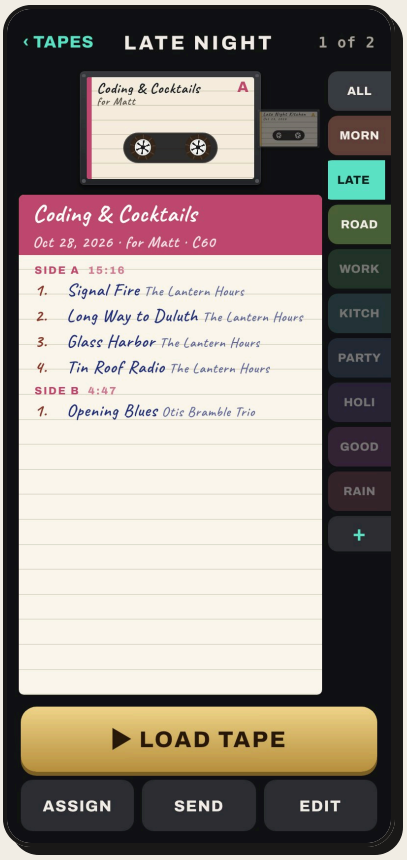
The sketch always shows whether the order fits a C60 or a C90. When it's right, **Make It a Tape**. New to this? Read **The Art of the Mixtape** in the Sketch Pad, or at `ownyourmedia.club/flipside/art`.



A place for every tape.

STOP/EJECT opens your **tape rack**: every tape on its spine, grouped by drawer (Morning, Late Night, Road Trip, Workout, Kitchen, Party, Holiday, Feel Good, Rainy Day and your own), newest first.

- **The tabs** down the right edge jump to a drawer. **+** makes a new one; press and hold a tab to rename it or take it out.
- **Lift a tape** by tapping it: it comes up big with its song list. Swipe for the next tape in that drawer. **LOAD TAPE** puts it in the deck.
- **ASSIGN** files it in as many drawers as you like; **SEND** and **EDIT** are right there too. ⌕ searches tapes, people and songs.
- Your drawers match on every device through a small **Flipside Drawers & Wishlist** playlist in Plex. Leave it there.



Lift a tape: its songs, then LOAD TAPE

Why It's Here

A line about why a song is on the tape: "the song we played on repeat driving up to Duluth." Write one from the deck's **SONGS** list (tap the song), with **+ Why** in the Workbench, with **+ NOTE** in TV Mode, or in Menu › Mixtapes. Notes travel with the tape when you send it.

TV Mode

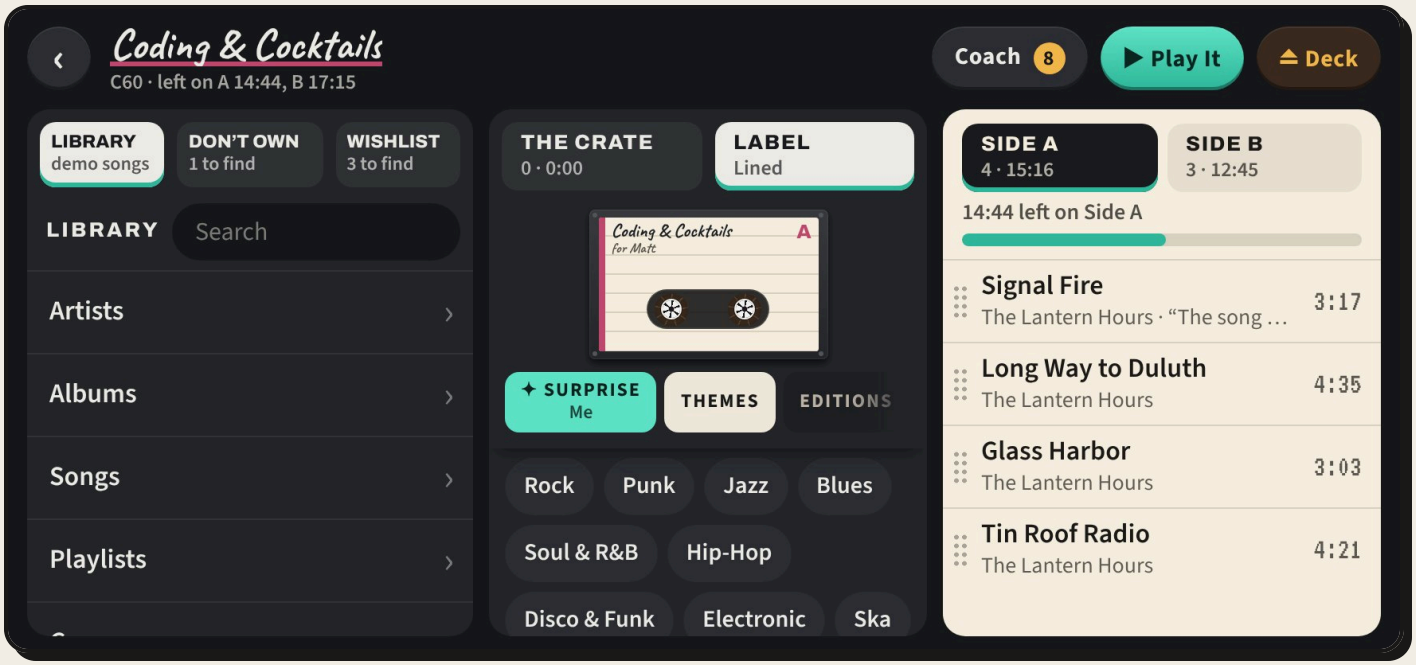
Made for Screen Mirroring to a TV (on iPhone: Control Center › Screen Mirroring › your Apple TV). Open it from Menu › TV Mode, or the **TV** button on the deck sideways. Your tape sits on a shelf with the song, a counter, VU meters, Up Next and the song's Why It's Here note. Tap anywhere for the tape keys; they fade so the TV stays clean.



TV Mode, as it looks on the TV

Turn your phone sideways.

On the menu side, turn the phone sideways for the **Workbench**: your library on the left, the crate in the middle and Side A and Side B on the right. Press and hold a song to drag it; tap a song for quick buttons. Swipe across the columns for more room. Turn it upright and you're on the same tape in the menu.



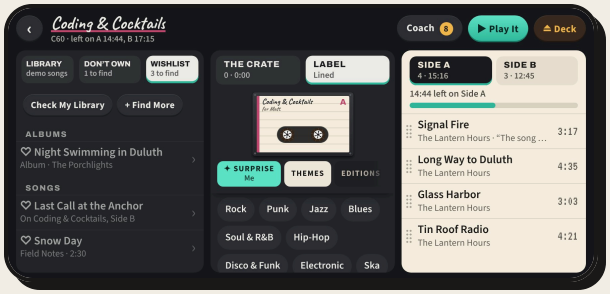
The Label tab: one list at a time, each showing what's picked

Dress it up: the Label Maker

The **Label** tab beside the crate (or Menu › Label Maker) has a tab for each choice: **Themes** (sixteen music themes, one press each), **Editions**, **Paper**, **Pen**, **Ink**, **Stripe** and **Shell**, now including Glow in the Dark, See-Through Red, Blue, Green and Purple, and Woodgrain. ✦ **Surprise Me** leads the row; **Start Over** is at the bottom. The deck can dress up too: Settings › Deck Color has the **Sport** line, **Retro** (Brushed Aluminum, See-Through, 80s Pastel) and **Editions**.

The Wishlist

Everything you want to own, in one list. In **Don't Own** search, tap a result and press ♡ **Song** or ♡ **Album**. They join every ♡ song already on a tape (with which tape it's on). Find it in the Workbench beside Library and Don't Own, or Menu › Mixtapes › Wishlist. Each item has buy links; **Check My Library** moves anything you've added to Plex to Found. It follows you to your other devices.

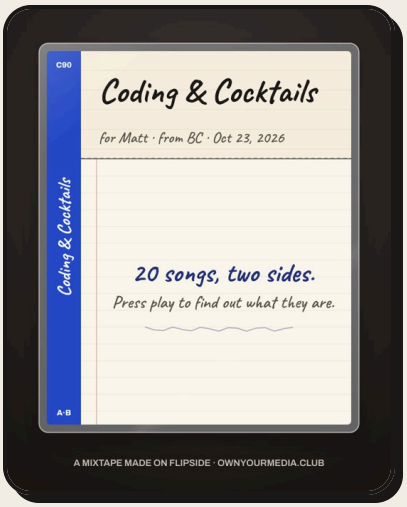


Give it away.

1. Load a tape and press **SEND MIXTAPE** (or Send Mixtape on the tape's menu).

2. **Song list: Surprise** (the default) keeps the songs secret until they've heard the whole tape. **Shown** writes every song on the card.

3. Pick a person on your Plex server (share your Plex music library with them first). Your share sheet opens with a picture of the tape and the link. On a computer, the picture downloads and Mail opens.



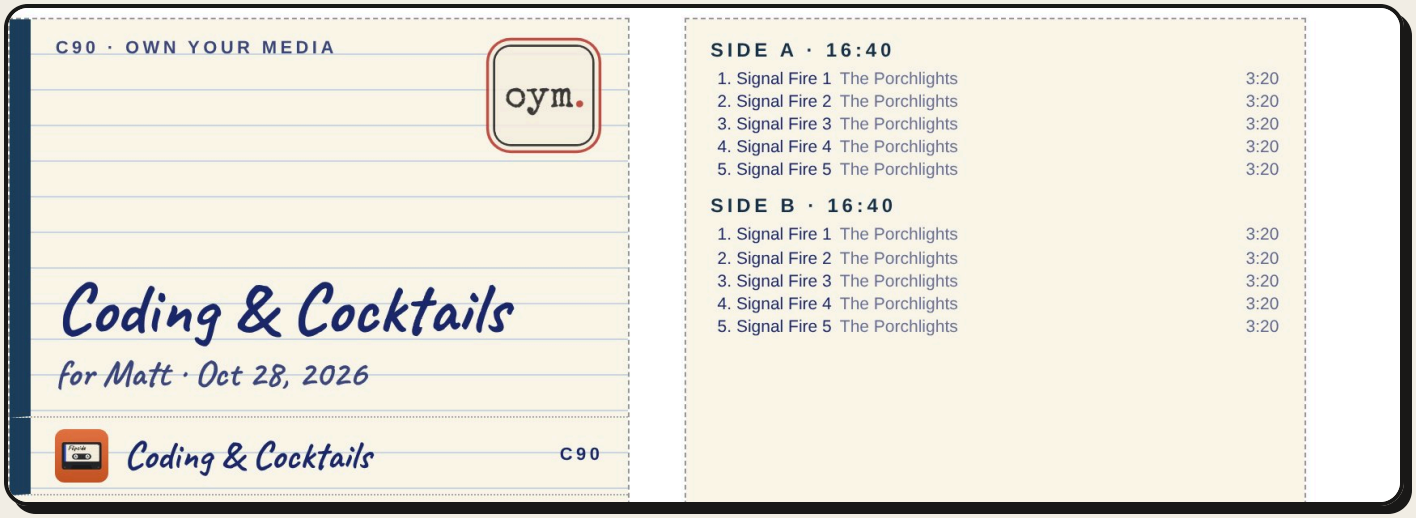
The card they get (Surprise)

When someone sends you a tape

Tap the link, choose **See the Card** or **Add It to My Tapes**. It's a surprise: while it plays, only the current song is written on the tape, and the track list says "keep listening…". Hear it all, both sides, and the song list is yours. Their Why It's Here notes come along.

Print the J-card

On a tape's menu, **Print the J-Card** makes a paper insert for a real cassette case. It wears your tape's label on light paper, with the Flipside icon on the spine, the Own Your Media Club stamp in the corner and Made with Flipside along the bottom. Long tapes get a second inside panel for Side B that folds behind Side A. Print at 100%, cut on the dashed line and fold on the dotted lines.



8 · ANALOG MODE AND COMPUTERS

Flipside, anywhere. No signal needed.

Menu › Settings › **Analog Mode**. With it on, every tape lives on your phone and plays with no signal: on a plane, up north, in the basement. The lamp on the deck says **ANALOG** when it's playing from the phone.

- **Recording really records:** each song you add is copied onto the phone.
- Tapes sent to you **dub when you add them**. Tapes not on the phone yet look faded; press PLAY with a signal to dub one, or use **Dub All My Tapes**.
- **Dub on Wi-Fi.** A full C90 is about 90 MB at Space Saver and 220 MB at High; ten tapes take about 1–2 GB.
- Add Flipside to your Home Screen first, so your phone keeps the tapes.

On a computer, open the link and choose **Switch to Desktop Mode**. The deck fills the window in your deck color, the door opens to your tapes with the drawers along the top, and Menu opens the Workbench, where you drag songs with the mouse.

9 · WHAT TO TEST

Here's what I most want to hear about.

Make and play

Fill a C60. Do the keys feel right? Does the flip feel like a flip?

The rack

File a few tapes, make a drawer of your own, search, and find a tape again. Does it make sense?

On the TV

Mirror TV Mode to a TV and play a tape with a Why It's Here note. How does it look from the couch?

Send a surprise

Did the picture and link come through? Did the songs stay hidden on their end, and did your notes show up?

Print a J-card

Do the colors, stamp and song list come out right, and does it fold into a real case?

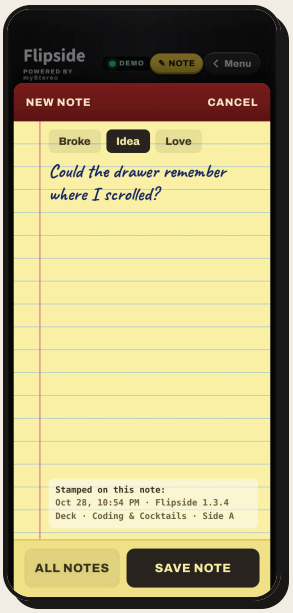
Your phone

Upright and sideways, big phone or small: anything cut off, too small or hard to tap? Does music keep playing with the screen locked or on AirPlay?

Notes, known limits and quick fixes.

Press **✎ NOTE** on the deck any time something breaks, gives you an idea or makes you smile. Pick **Broke**, **Idea** or **Love** and write a line. Each note is stamped with where you were and what was playing. When you're ready, Menu › Alpha › **Notepad** › **Send All to BC** puts every note in one email, with the details you choose. No mail app? Copy them, or write to `bc@runawayanchor.com`.

Menu › Alpha also has **What to Test**, **What's New**, the **Quick Start Guide**, **Copy Playback Log** and **Restore Sketches & Tapes**.



Known limits in this alpha

- Sketches stay on the device you made them on. Tapes, drawers and the Wishlist sync through Plex; sketches don't yet.
- Your friend hears your tape from your server, so you need to share your Plex music library with them first.
- Very wide pens (like Fancy) can still get cut off on a tape spine.

Quick fixes

First PLAY is silent	Phones only start sound after a tap. Press PLAY again; check the volume and the iPhone ring switch.
Can't reach Plex	Make sure your server is on with Remote Access turned on, then Settings › Music Sources › Plex › Reconnect.
Lamp says NOT DUBBED	You're offline and this tape isn't on the phone. Turn on Analog Mode while you have Wi-Fi.
Tape missing elsewhere	Mixtapes › Sync with Plex on both devices, signed in to the same server.
Friend can't play a tape	Share your Plex music library with them, then send it again.
"Keep listening..."	It's a surprise tape. Hear the whole thing and the songs appear.
Icon looks old	Remove Flipside from your Home Screen and add it again. Your sign-in and tapes stay.

App: `ownyourmedia.club/flipside/app` · User's Guide: Menu › Settings › User's Guide · About Us: Menu › Settings › About Us · The Art of the Mixtape: `ownyourmedia.club/flipside/art`

Who are you making a tape for?

Thanks again for being here. Now go make someone a mixtape.